Voting in Ancient Athens Simulation Workshop (60 minutes)

Goals:

Students are invited to:

- Expand on / refresh their knowledge about the origins of democracy and the voting process in ancient Athens,
- Participate in a simulation debate following the voting process in ancient Athens.

1. Introduction (5 minutes)

- **Objectives**:
- Activate previous knowledge
- Briefly introduce Ancient Athens and its significance in the history of democracy.
- **Activity**:
- Students brainstorm on the topic
- Teacher presents and explains the concept of democracy, emphasizing its Athenian origins.

2. The ancient Athenian Voting System (10 minutes)

- **Objective**: Enhance students' knowledge on how the ancient Greek voting system worked.
- **Activities**
    - **Presentation**:
        - Explain the Assembly ("Ekklesia"), where citizens gathered to vote on important issues.
        - Describe the process of ostracism, where citizens could vote to exile a person for ten years.
        - Highlight the importance of the "Vouli" (Council of 500) and how members were chosen.
        - Emphasize the democratic value of equality between Athenian citizens to take the floor.
        - Stress the impact on modern society.

3. Simulation Activity (15-20 minutes)

- **Objectives**: Allow students to experience the Athenian voting process,

  Participate in a debate and enrich argumentative EFL speaking skills,

  Cultivate acceptance of opposing views.

- **Activities**:
    - **Setup**:

The teacher:

- Appoints a student as the “state presiding official” to address the audience with the initial proposal to be voted for or against later on.
- Divides students into small groups, each representing different segments of Athenian society (parents-teachers-students-ministry of education officials).
- Gives each group the scenario cards to discuss (“penalty for mobile phone misuse at school”) and sticks team badges to each member.

- **Simulation**:
  - Each group discusses their scenario and prepares arguments for and/or against the issue.
  - Groups present their arguments to the class.
  - Conduct a mock vote (via raising hands) to simulate the ancient voting process. Results exhibited on blackboard, simulating the ancient Athens voting procedure.

4. Discussion: Then and Now (10 minutes)

- **Objective**: Draw parallels between ancient and modern democratic processes.
- **Activities**:
  - Facilitate a discussion on the similarities and differences between ancient Athenian democracy and modern democratic systems.
  - Discuss the importance of participation in elections today, drawing on historical examples from the workshop.

5. Conclusion and Reflection (10 minutes)

- **Objective**: Summarize the key points and reflect on the activity.
- **Activities**:
  - Students share what they learned and how they felt about the voting process.
  - Whole group talk to emphasize the importance of civic engagement and informed voting in contemporary society.

Materials Needed:

- Presentation on Ancient Athens and its democratic processes.
- Props for the simulation activity (microphone, class projector, presiding official’s introductory speech, scenario cards, team badges).

Appendix I – Introductory Presentation

https://prezi.com/p/q1u4d8mr1ke-/?present=1

Appendix II – Team Badges



debateteams.pdf

Appendix III



Presiding Official's Introductory Proposal.pdf

Appendix IV



Destroying mobile phones.pdf